

# North Star Defense Card

**Day 2 · Activity 2 handout.** The card your triad locks its North Star into: the statement, a rebuttal to each of the three pitfalls, and a counter-metric that guards against gameability. Extended in Activity 3 with the CEO and dispatcher challenges.

Fill the template below. Keep each rebuttal under 30 words.

## ## North Star

We are winning when [outcome] increases for [segment],  
measured by [number].

## ## Pitfall rebuttals

- **Vanity:** Why does this number changing mean a customer's life got better?  
> [your answer in <30 words]
- **Leading-indicator:** Could a team move this without the customer being  
meaningfully better off?  
> [your answer]
- **Gameable:** What's the most cynical way a team could hit this without earning it?  
> [your answer + the guardrail you'd add]

## ## Counter-metric (the guardrail)

A second metric that, if it moves *the wrong way*, signals we're winning the NS  
for the wrong reasons.  
> [counter-metric]

## What a counter-metric looks like

A counter-metric is concrete and paired with the NS, not a vague "we'd watch retention." For example:

- NS = "Hours of returned dispatcher time" → Counter = "% of dispatchers calling support after the new flow"
- NS = "Tickets resolved without escalation" → Counter = "Rate of repeated tickets from the same customer"

## Activity 3 addendum — the CEO & Dispatcher test

After role-playing both personas, add the strongest challenge from each and how you'd address it.

**CEO's strongest challenge:**

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**How we'd address it:**

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Dispatcher's strongest challenge:

How we'd address it: